

1 / 5 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

Lost-and-found story

What we are practising

Link story events with a clear cause and result.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Tell the story aloud instead of writing it.

Before you begin

Draw three empty boxes on a sheet.

Share fictional details; no personal addresses or names are needed.

Try it together

1. Choose a lost object, such as a red hat.
2. In box one, show who lost it and where.
3. In box two, add a clue; in box three, show how the clue helps find it.
4. Retell the story using first, then and finally.

Talk, draw or show your idea

How did the clue change what the character did?

Space to explore

2 / 5 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

Describe without naming

What we are practising

Choose descriptive words and ask useful questions.

What you need

No materials

Choose imaginary objects if the room has few examples.

Before you begin

Agree that players will stay in place and choose safe everyday objects.

Do not handle sharp, hot or electrical objects; describe them only if needed.

Try it together

1. Secretly choose an object, such as a spoon.
2. Give three clues about shape, material or use without naming it.
3. Let your partner ask two yes-or-no questions, then guess.
4. Swap roles and discuss which clue helped most.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Which clue ruled out the most other objects?

Space to explore

3 / 5 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

Facts or guesses?

What we are practising

Support a reading answer with evidence from the text.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Read the scene aloud and answer orally.

Before you begin

Write: Lina entered with a wet umbrella. She put it beside the door.

Use a fictional scene; this is about text evidence, not judging real people.

Try it together

1. Read the two sentences twice.
2. Label each statement fact or guess: the umbrella was wet; it was raining outside; Lina put it by the door.
3. Point to words that support each fact.
4. Invent another possible reason for a wet umbrella.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Can something be a sensible guess without being stated?

Space to explore

4 / 5 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

Instructions that work

What we are practising

Give ordered instructions using position and size words.

What you need

Two sheets of paper / Pencils

Trace shapes in the air while the partner describes them back.

Before you begin

Sit so each person's paper is hidden from the other.

Keep feedback about the instructions rather than artistic skill.

Try it together

1. Draw a large circle with a small triangle above it and two dots inside.
2. Describe one part at a time without showing your drawing.
3. Let your partner ask questions, then compare the drawings.
4. Rewrite one unclear instruction and try again.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Which missing detail caused the biggest difference?

Space to explore

5 / 5 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

Two voices, one event

What we are practising

Distinguish an event from a character's feelings about it.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Act out both voices without writing.

Before you begin

Choose this event: rain begins during a picnic.

Use imagined situations and allow children to skip any uncomfortable role.

Try it together

1. Describe the rain in one neutral sentence.
2. Speak as a person who wants dry sandwiches.
3. Speak as a nearby gardener pleased about watering plants.
4. Compare what stayed the same and which feelings changed.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Can both characters describe the same event honestly?

Space to explore

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

1. Lost-and-found story

A little hint

A useful clue might be a photo showing where the hat was left.

Answer / what to notice

Many endings work if the clue genuinely helps find the object.

A connected ending follows from earlier events rather than appearing by chance.

Make it easier

Draw pictures and let an adult write your words.

Take it further

Add a misleading clue and explain why it was unhelpful.

Another day, away from the screen

Retell the same events from the hat's point of view.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

2. Describe without naming

A little hint

For a spoon, describe a small bowl at the end of a handle.

Answer / what to notice

Accept a guess that fits every clue; refine a clue if several objects fit.

Specific features distinguish an object better than broad words such as nice.

Make it easier

Choose from three visible objects.

Take it further

Describe an object without mentioning its usual use.

Another day, away from the screen

Collect five precise describing words during an ordinary conversation.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

3. Facts or guesses?

A little hint

The text never tells us the weather.

Answer / what to notice

Wet umbrella: fact. Rain outside: guess. Beside the door: fact.

Rain is plausible, but the umbrella could have been washed; evidence limits what we know.

Make it easier

Check only the first two statements.

Take it further

Add a sentence that confirms or disproves the rain guess.

Another day, away from the screen

Find one stated fact and one inference in a story you already own.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

4. Instructions that work

A little hint

Say whether the triangle touches the circle and where the dots sit.

Answer / what to notice

Drawings need not be identical; improvement means more agreed features match.

A listener needs details that the speaker can see but has not yet described.

Make it easier

Use only a circle and one dot.

Take it further

Give all instructions before the partner starts drawing.

Another day, away from the screen

Write clear instructions for folding a sheet in half, then test them.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

5. Two voices, one event

A little hint

Keep the weather identical but change what each character needs.

Answer / what to notice

Both accounts can fit: rain wets the picnic and also waters the garden.

Different needs can produce different reactions to the same facts.

Make it easier

Choose between happy and disappointed for each character.

Take it further

Add a third character with mixed feelings and explain why.

Another day, away from the screen

Retell a familiar fairy tale from a minor character's viewpoint.